Terminus Rift

Quick Start

Fill a character sheet. Play tonight.

Companion to the *Core Rulebook* (v0.13.15)

Version 0.1.0

Credits

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Quick Start

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This booklet restates chargen and sheet math from the Core Rulebook.
If a line ever disagrees, the Core Rulebook wins.

Chapter 1

Using This Booklet

This booklet gets a new player from a blank page to a filled 1st-level character sheet. It is a companion to the *Terminus Rift Core Rulebook* (v0.13.15), not a second rule set. Flavour, ancestry features, class powers, feats, full equipment, combat, and magic live in that book. When a line here and a line there disagree, the Core Rulebook wins.

Terminus Rift is a tabletop roleplaying game of survival and discovery on Vellmir, a tidally locked world split by scorching day, frozen night, and a narrow habitable twilight. One player is the **Rift Master** (RM). Everyone else plays a character who lives in that world.

1.0.1 What This Booklet Does

- Walks character creation on the **Quick-Start** career path (about fifteen minutes once you know the tables).
- Gives the numbers you write on the sheet: attributes, Hit Points, defences, skills, starting gold, and a short gear list.
- Points at the Core Rulebook chapter that holds the rest.

1.0.2 What It Does Not Do

- The full life-path (one to three career terms with qualification, events, and mishaps). That is Core Rulebook, Character Creation, Step 5.
- Ancestral templates, pre-career education, ancestry feats, and class power lists.
- A complete first-session adventure. The RM still needs the Core Rulebook (and, for running the table, the *Rift Master's Guide*).

1.0.3 What You Need

- Polyhedral dice: d4, d6, d8, d10, d12, d20. Percentile (d100) is two d10s.
- A character sheet (Appendix B of this booklet, or Core Rulebook Appendix D).
- Pencil and eraser.
- The Core Rulebook at the table for powers, ancestry features, and anything this booklet marks *see CRB*.
- Three to six people: one RM and two to five players is the sweet spot.

1.0.4 Reading Dice

2d6 means roll two six-sided dice and add them. **1d8+3** means roll one eight-sided die and add 3. The number before the "d" is how many dice; the number after is how many sides.

1.0.5 Vellmir in Brief

Vellmir is tidally locked to its star. One face burns, one face freezes, and almost everyone lives in the terminator – a twilight belt of cities, storms, and the Twilight Sea. Dayside is forge-heat and dust. Nightside is ice under the crimson moon Blodmåne. Below the crust, Djupheim's caverns run for miles. **Rifts** tear reality open at random; they are the setting's wound and its adventure hook. Full cosmology, factions, and weather: Core Rulebook, Introduction and Exploration.

Chapter 2

The Check

When the outcome of an action is uncertain, the RM calls for a **check**. Roll 1d20 and add modifiers:

d20 + attribute modifier + proficiency + other mods

Compare the total to the **Difficulty Class** (**DC**). Meet or beat it and you succeed. Full rules: Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics.

2.0.1 Eight Attributes

Four Facets of Form: **STR** (force you apply), **STA** (what your body absorbs; Hit Points), **AGI** (whole-body movement), **FIN** (precision of hands and aim).

Four Facets of Mind: **INT** (ideas and systems), **CUN** (projecting onto other minds), **INS** (receiving signals), **WIL** (holding the line).

Modifier = $\lfloor(\text{Score} - 10)/2\rfloor$. Score 10-11 is +0; 12-13 is +1; 8-9 is −1.

2.0.2 Proficiency

Rank	Rank Bonus
Untrained	+0 (do *not* add half level)
Trained	+2
Expert	+4
Master	+6
Grandmaster	+8

Proficiency bonus = rank bonus +$\lfloor$ level /2$\rfloor$. At 1st level, Trained is +2 and Expert is +4.

2.0.3 Degrees of Success

Beat the **DC** by 10 or more: critical success. Meet or exceed: success. Miss: failure. Miss by 10 or more: critical failure. The same four degrees apply when someone rolls *against* your defence.

2.0.4 Five Defences

You do not roll to defend. Attackers roll against a static number on your sheet.

AC 10 + max(AGI, INS)+ proficiency + armour + shield. Armour may cap the AGI portion; INS is never capped.
Fortitude 10 + max(STR, STA)+ proficiency.
Reflex 10 + max(AGI, FIN)+ proficiency.
Acuity 10 + max(INT, CUN)+ proficiency.
Resolve 10 + max(WIL, INS)+ proficiency.

Class sets your starting rank in each defence. Combat, three-action turns, reactions, and conditions: Core Rulebook, Combat and Core Mechanics.

2.0.5 Typical Difficulty

Difficulty	DC
Easy	10
Moderate	15
Hard	20
Very hard	25

The RM adjusts for circumstances. Do not roll if the task is trivial or impossible.

Chapter 3

Make a Character

Follow these steps in order. This booklet uses the **Quick-Start** career path (Core Rulebook, Character Creation, Step 5). Skip pre-career education and ancestral templates unless the table already knows those options; both are optional and live in the Core Rulebook.

Character Creation Summary

1. **Ancestry** – One of nine ancestries (variants where listed). Attribute bonuses, ancestry HP, size, speed, skills, features.
2. **Attributes** – Point buy, standard array, or 4d6 drop lowest. Apply ancestry bonuses. No score above 18 at 1st level.
3. **Origin** – Where you grew up. One minor benefit.
4. **Background** – Two skill trainings, a background ability, starting gear.
5. **Career** (**Quick-Start**) – Pick one Career Archetype packet. Skip the full life-path.
6. **Class** – One of twelve classes. Key attributes, HP, proficiencies, 1st-level features and powers (*see CRB*).
7. **Finishing** – Alignment, Rift Mark, buy extra gear, personality.

Overlap rule: If a step grants Trained in a skill you already have Trained, you become Expert instead. Proficiency upgrades only one step per overlap. If you are already Expert or higher, that overlap does not advance further (the RM may let you take Trained in a related skill instead).

3.1 Step 1: Ancestry

Choose one ancestry. Lycanthrope, Khithari, and Feldarí also pick a variant. Write attribute bonuses, ancestry HP, size, and speed on the sheet. Copy feature names from the table; full text is Core Rulebook, Ancestries.

Ancestry (variant)	Attributes	HP	Sz	Spd	Write on the sheet
Human	+2 any, +1 any	8	M	30	Adaptable (extra skill); Ambitious Drive (extra general feat at 1st).
Steinfolk	+2 STA, +1 WIL	10	M	25	Darkvision 60 ft; Stonecunning; Steinfolk Resilience; Craft Heritage (Trained Crafting). Speed not reduced by heavy armour.
Lysari	+2 FIN, +1 INT	6	M	30	Low-light vision; Keen Senses (Trained Perception); Lysari Longevity; Arcana or Nature.
Korvani	+2 FIN, +1 CUN	6	S	25	Brave; Korvani Luck; Nimble; River Craft (Stealth or Thievery).
Drakvari	+2 STR, +1 STA	8	M	30	Draconic element, breath weapon, energy resistance – Core Rulebook, Ancestries.
Lycanthrope (Vargr)	+2 STR, +1 INS	8	M	30	Shifting and lunar bond – Core Rulebook, Ancestries (Úlfhednar).
Lycanthrope (Bjørn)	+2 STA, +1 STR	12	L	25	As above.
Lycanthrope (Visundr)	+2 STR, +1 STA	10	L	30	As above.
Lycanthrope (Refr)	+2 CUN, +1 FIN	6	S	30	As above.
Skuggari	+2 INT, +1 FIN	6	M	30	Superior darkvision; shadow features – Core Rulebook, Ancestries.
Khithari (Razorblade)	+2 AGI, +1 INS	6	M	30	Four arms, hive echo – Core Rulebook, Ancestries.
Khithari (Ironshell)	+2 STA, +1 STR	10	M	25	As above.
Feldarí (Solkatt)	+2 STR, +1 CUN	10	M	30	Claws, feline grace, whisker sense – Core Rulebook, Ancestries.
Feldarí (Randýr)	+2 AGI, +1 STR	8	M	35	As above.
Feldarí (Isfeld)	+2 FIN, +1 INS	6	M	30	As above.

Sz = Size: S Small, M Medium, L Large. Spd = base land Speed (feet). After ancestry bonuses, no attribute may exceed 18 at 1st level; excess is lost.

Optional ancestral template (at most one): Core Rulebook, Ancestries, Ancestral Templates. Skip it for a first character.

3.2 Step 2: Attributes

Agree on one method before anyone writes scores.

3.2.1 Point Buy (Default)

All attributes start at 10. You have **32 points**. No attribute may exceed 15 before ancestry bonuses.

Score	Cost	Score	Cost
8	−2	12	2
9	−1	13	3
10	0	14	5
11	1	15	7

Lowering a score to 8 or 9 refunds points.

3.2.2 Standard Array

Assign **16, 15, 14, 13, 12, 11, 10, 8** in any order.

3.2.3 Random (4d6 Drop Lowest)

Roll 4d6 eight times, drop the lowest die each time, assign freely. The RM may allow a reroll if the eight scores sum to less than 88 or no score is 14 or higher.

Then apply Step 1 bonuses and write each modifier in the circle under the score.

3.3 Step 3: Origin

Choose where you grew up. If the origin grants Trained in a skill you already have, overlap applies.

Dayside Fire resistance equal to half your level (minimum 1). Trained in Survival (or Expert if you already are).
Terminator One extra language. Trained in Society (or Expert).
Nightside Darkvision 30 ft (or +30 ft if you already have it). Trained in Stealth (or Expert).
Djupheim / Caverns Tremorsense 15 ft. Trained in Perception (or Expert).

Veil-touched Once per long rest, when a magical effect hits one of your defences, force the attacker to reroll and use the worse result. TRAINED in Arcana (or EXPERT).

3.4 Step 4: Background

Choose or roll d20 (on 20, roll d4: 1-2 Tinkerer, 3 Explorer, 4 Spelunker). Each background grants two skill trainings, a named ability, and a gear package. Full ability text: Core Rulebook, Character Creation, Background Descriptions. Write the ability name on the sheet and look it up when it matters.

#	Background	Skills	Ability	Gear (short)	gp
1	Acolyte	Religion, Diplomacy	Shelter of Faith	Holy symbol, prayer book, incense, vestments	15
2	Artisan	Crafting, Society	Guild Membership	Artisan's tools, guild letter, traveller's clothes	15
3	Charlatan	Deception, Thievery	False Identity	Fine clothes, disguise kit, forged papers	15
4	Criminal	Stealth, Intimidation	Underworld Contact	Crowbar, hooded clothes, thieves' tools	15
5	Entertainer	Performance, Diplomacy	By Popular Demand	Instrument, costume	15
6	Farmer	Nature, Athletics	Rustic Hospitality	Shovel, iron pot, seeds or spores, common clothes	10
7	Fisher	Survival, Nature	Storm Sense	Fishing tackle, net, oilskin	10
8	Guard	Athletics, Intimidation	Watcher's Eye	Light armour, a simple weapon, manacles	10
9	Healer	Medicine, Nature	Field Medic	Healer's kit (10), herbalism kit	15
10	Hermit	Religion, Survival	Discovery	Scroll case, winter blanket, herbalism kit, common clothes	5
11	Hunter	Survival, Stealth	Prey Sense	Hunting trap, shortbow (20 arrows), skinning knife, traveller's clothes	10
12	Laborer	Athletics, Crafting	Born Tough (+1 HP/level)	Hammer, 50 ft rope, common clothes	10
13	Merchant	Diplomacy, Society	Shrewd Bargainer	Fine clothes, scale, ledger, mule or handcart	25
14	Miner	Athletics, Survival	Stonecunning	Miner's pick, lantern, 2 oil, common clothes	10
15	Noble	Society, Diplomacy	Position of Privilege	Fine clothes, signet, pedigree scroll	25
16	Sailor	Athletics, Piloting	Sea Legs	Belaying pin (club), 50 ft rope, common clothes	10
17	Scholar	Arcana, Lore	Researcher	Scholar's pack, 3 books, common clothes	15
18	Rift Orphan	Occultism, Survival	Rift Sense	Tattered clothes, crystal shard (5 gp)	5
19	Street Urchin	Thievery, Stealth	City Secrets	Small knife, home-city map, common clothes, small pet	10
20	Tinkerer	Crafting, Technology	Jury-Rig	Tinker's tools, clockwork toy, common clothes	15
21	Explorer	Navigation, Survival	Trailblazer	Navigator's kit, 50 ft rope, common clothes	10
22	Spelunker	Dungeoneering, Athletics	Caver's Instinct	Miner's pick, 50 ft rope, grappling hook, lantern, 2 oil, common clothes	10

Optional pre-career education (one 4-year university or apprenticeship term that does *not* count toward the 1-3 career cap): Core Rulebook, Character Creation, Step 4.5. Skip it here.

3.5 Step 5: Career (Quick-Start)

Do not roll qualification, survival, career events, or mishaps. Pick one packet. Apply two skill trainings (overlap applies), one fixed mustering-out benefit, and a +**4 year** age bump (one equivalent term). No career event, no extra Rift Surge from this step.

Soldier Athletics, Intimidation. One simple or martial weapon (up to 25 gp).
Wanderer Survival, Stealth. 2d6 gp and one minor contact in a settlement you name. Closest packet to the Drifter aesthetic.
Scholar Lore, Arcana. Scholar's pack and one book on a subject you choose.
Healer Medicine, and Religion *or* Nature. Healer's kit (10 uses) and a contact among clergy or wilderness folk.
Outlaw Stealth, Deception. Thieves' tools and a contact in a criminal underground.
Initiate Occultism, Survival. A cosmetic psionic focus, a vague unfinished-training memory, and +2d6 gp.

Each class entry in the Core Rulebook names a suggested Quick-Start archetype (Warrior → Soldier, and so on). You may mix freely.

You may later run real career terms in downtime.

Skills already trained upgrade per the overlap rule. A mishap from a retroactive term is a past event you already survived; apply the mechanical effect anyway. Full life-path: Core Rulebook, Character Creation, Step 5.

3.6 Step 6: Class

Choose one class. Write key attributes, recovery die, 1st-level HP, defence ranks, and class skills. At 1st level you also choose **3 Techniques** (at-will), **2 Exploits** (encounter), and **1 Gambit** (daily) from that class's lists — Core Rulebook, Classes. Write the names on the sheet; the full power text stays in that chapter.

1st-level Hit Points = ancestry HP + class HP + STA modifier.

Class	Keys	HP	Rec	Fort	Ref	Acu	Res	Per
Warrior	STR, AGI	12+STA	d12	E	T	T	T	E
Rogue	FIN, CUN	8+STA	d8	T	E	T	T	E
Ranger	AGI, INS	10+STA	d10	T	T	T	T	E
Bard	CUN, INS	8+STA	d8	T	T	T	T	E
Priest	WIL, INS	8+STA	d8	T	T	T	E	T
Paladin	STR, WIL	10+STA	d10	E	T	T	T	T
Druid	INS, WIL	8+STA	d8	T	T	T	E	T
Artificer	INT, FIN	8+STA	d8	T	T	T	T	T
Wizard	INT, WIL	6+STA	d6	T	T	T	E	T
Sorcerer	WIL, CUN	6+STA	d6	T	T	T	E	T
Psionicist	WIL, INT	6+STA	d6	T	T	T	E	E
Shaman	INS, INT	8+STA	d8	T	T	T	E	E

T = Trained (+2 at 1st level). E = Expert (+4 at 1st level). Rec = Recovery Die. Acu = Acuity. Res = Resolve. Per = Perception. Armour and weapon training: copy from the class's Initial Proficiencies table (Core Rulebook, Classes).

Class	Class skills (all Trained)	QS packet	Gold
Warrior	Athletics + 3 others	Soldier (alt. Outlaw)	15 gp
Rogue	Stealth, Thievery + 5 others	Outlaw	12 gp
Ranger	Nature, Survival, Navigation + 3 others	Wanderer	15 gp
Bard	Occultism, Performance + 5 others	Scholar or Outlaw	12 gp
Priest	Religion + 3 others	Healer or Initiate	12 gp
Paladin	Religion + 3 others	Soldier or Healer	15 gp
Druid	Nature + 3 others	Wanderer or Healer	12 gp
Artificer	Crafting, Arcana, Technology + 2 others	Scholar	12 gp
Wizard	Arcana + 3 others	Scholar	10 gp
Sorcerer	Arcana or Intimidation + 3 others	Initiate or Outlaw	10 gp
Psionicist	Occultism or Arcana + 3 others	Initiate	10 gp
Shaman	Nature + 3 others	Healer or Wanderer	10 gp

Class gold is *in addition to* background gold and Quick-Start benefits. Doctrine, oath, muse, racket, totem, companion, Spell Reserve, and Effort: Core Rulebook, Classes. Write the choice name in the Oath / Doctrine / Totem line if your class has one.

3.7 Step 7: Finishing Touches

3.7.1 Alignment

Nine options on two axes: Lawful / Neutral / Chaotic and Good / Neutral / Evil. Alignment feeds reaction rolls and social mechanics. Full grid: Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics, Alignment.

3.7.2 Rift Mark

One extraordinary fact that is true of no one else in the world. Mechanically neutral; it is a story hook.

Guidance and examples: Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics, Rift Mark.

3.7.3 Age

Starting age = ancestry base + 4 years (this booklet's one Quick-Start term). All player characters begin at **level 1** regardless of terms served.

Ancestry	Base Age
Human, Drakvari, Lycanthrope	18
Korvani, Skuggari, Khithari, Feldarí	20
Steinfolk	25
Lysari	30

3.7.4 Personality

Name, appearance, a few traits, what they want, what they fear, and why they left ordinary work for the rifts. Cosmic bonds (factions, deities) are roleplay; define two or three with the RM.

Sheet Checklist

Before you sit down to play, the sheet should have:

- Name, ancestry (variant), class, level 1, age.
- Eight scores and eight modifiers.
- Max HP, Speed, Recovery Die, Perception rank and modifier.
- AC, Fortitude, Reflex, Acuity, Resolve (each with a rank).
- Every TRAINED and EXPERT skill, with its key attribute.
- Background ability name, Quick-Start packet, class gold remaining.
- One weapon (at least), armour or unarmoured, shield if any.
- Three Technique names, two Exploit names, one Gambit name (from Core Rulebook, Classes).
- Alignment, Rift Mark, and one sentence of motivation.

Powers, ancestry feature text, and doctrine / oath / totem details stay in the Core Rulebook. Names go on the sheet so you know which page to open.

Chapter 4

Fill the Sheet

Work top to bottom. Blank sheet: Appendix B.

4.0.1 Identity

Name, player, Level **1**, ancestry (and variant), class, and oath / doctrine / totem if the class has one.

4.0.2 Attributes

Scores and modifiers from Step 2.

4.0.3 Hit Points

Current = Max = ancestry HP + class HP + STA modifier. Laborer's Born Tough adds +1 per level (so +1 at 1st). Temporary HP starts empty.

4.0.4 Armour Class

AC = 10 + max(AGI (capped), INS)+ armour proficiency + armour bonus + shield (while Raised). Unarmoured: 10 + max(AGI, INS)+ proficiency. Copy armour proficiency from the class table (Core Rulebook, Classes). AGI Cap and check / speed penalties: Core Rulebook, Equipment.

4.0.5 Other Defences

Each of Fortitude, Reflex, Acuity, and Resolve uses the formula in Chapter 2 and the T/E rank from Step 6.

4.0.6 Speed, Perception, Recovery

Speed is ancestry speed, then apply armour speed penalty if any. Perception modifier = INS modifier + proficiency (rank from the class statistics block). Recovery Die is the class die + STA modifier.

4.0.7 Rift Surges

Three uses. Full rules: Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics, Rift Surges.

4.0.8 Skills

Write every skill you are Trained or Expert in. Untrained skills still use the attribute modifier; they do *not* add half level.

Skill	Key	Skill	Key
Acrobatics	AGI	Navigation	INS
Arcana	INT	Nature	INS
Astronomy	INT	Occultism	INT
Athletics	STR	Perception	INS
Crafting	INT	Performance	CUN
Deception	CUN	Piloting	AGI
Diplomacy	CUN	Religion	WIL
Dungeoneering	INT or INS	Society	INT
Engineering	INT	Stealth	FIN
Intimidation	STR or CUN	Survival	CUN
Lore	INT	Technology	INT
Medicine	INT	Thievery	FIN
Meteorology	INS		

Full actions, trained-only tags, and skill feats: Core Rulebook, Skills & Feats.

4.0.9 Weapons

For each weapon: attack = d20 + attribute mod + weapon proficiency. Melee uses STR (FIN if the weapon has Finesse). Ranged uses FIN; thrown uses STR. Damage = weapon die + the same attribute (ranged non-thrown adds no attribute unless a feature says otherwise).

4.0.10 Powers

Leave three Technique lines, two Exploit lines, and one Gambit line. Choose them from your class lists (Core Rulebook, Classes). Spell Reserve and Effort, if any, are in that same class entry.

4.1 Starter Gear

You already have background gear, the Quick-Start benefit, and class starting gold. Spend remaining gold here. Prices assume a terminator settlement. Full lists, traits, armour groups, and Vellmir-specific kits: Core Rulebook, Equipment.

1 gp = 10 sp = 100 cp.

A first character can buy an **Explorer's Pack** (10 gp): backpack, bedroll, 5 days of rations, waterskin, flint and steel, 5 torches, 50 ft hemp rope, 10 chalk, sack.

4.1.1 Weapons You Can Likely Afford

Weapon	Price	Dmg	Type	Hands	Cat.	Notes
Club	–	1d6	B	1	Simple	Thrown 10 ft
Dagger	2 sp	1d4	P	1	Simple	Agile, Finesse, Thrown 10 ft, Versatile S
Handaxe	5 sp	1d6	S	1	Simple	Agile, Thrown 10 ft
Spear	1 gp	1d6	P	1	Simple	Thrown 20 ft, Two-Hand d8
Mace	5 gp	1d6	B	1	Simple	–
Pike	5 gp	1d8	P	2	Martial	Reach
Shortsword	10 gp	1d6	P	1	Martial	Agile, Finesse, Versatile S
Battleaxe	10 gp	1d8	S	1	Martial	Two-Hand d12
Sling	–	1d6	B	1	Simple	Range 50 ft
Shortbow	25 gp	1d6	P	2	Martial	Range 60 ft, Deadly d10

B bludgeoning, P piercing, S slashing. A Soldier packet may take one simple or martial weapon worth up to 25 gp as its benefit – that can be the shortbow or a 10 gp martial weapon without spending class gold.

4.1.2 Armour and Shields in Starting-Gold Range

Item	Price	AC	AGI Cap	Check	Speed	STR
Padded	2 sp	+1	+4	–	–	–
Leather	10 gp	+1	+4	−1	–	10
Hide	20 gp	+3	+2	−2	−5 ft	12
Buckler	5 gp	+1	–	–	–	–
Wooden Shield	10 gp	+2	–	–	–	–

Shield AC applies when you Raise Shield (**1** action). Heavier armour exists (studded leather 25 gp, scale 40 gp, chain 60 gp, full plate 300 gp) – Core Rulebook, Equipment. Do not add armour proficiency to AC if you wear armour you are not trained in.

4.1.3 Cheap Kits

Item	Price	Wt.
Backpack	2 gp	1 lb.
Healer's kit (10 uses)	5 gp	1 lb.
Crowbar	2 gp	5 lb.
Lantern, hooded	5 gp	2 lb.
Rope, hemp (50 ft)	1 gp	10 lb.
Grappling hook	2 gp	4 lb.
Waterskin	2 sp	5 lb. (full)
Rations (1 day)	5 sp	2 lb.
Glow moss (bundle)	3 sp	1 lb.

Thieves' tools are 25 gp – usually the Outlaw packet, not a gold purchase at 1st level. Heat shrouds, frost cloaks, and rift compasses are expedition gear (50-75 gp): Core Rulebook, Equipment, Vellmir-Specific Gear.

4.2 Worked Example (Quick-Start)

Yrsa Ashveil — Quick-Start Priest

Concept. Nightside-born Steinfolk hermit who heard a call and became a Priest. No life-path rolls.
Ancestry — Steinfolk. +2 STA, +1 WIL. Ancestry HP 10. Size Medium, Speed 25 ft. TRAINED Crafting. Darkvision 60 ft; Stonecunning; Steinfolk Resilience.
Attributes — standard array. STR 12, AGI 10, FIN 11, STA 15 (+2 = 17), INT 13, CUN 8, INS 14, WIL 16 (+1 = 17). Modifiers: STR +1, AGI +0, FIN +0, STA +3, INT +1, CUN −1, INS +2, WIL +3.
Origin — Nightside. Darkvision 30 ft stacks to 90 ft. TRAINED Stealth.
Background — Hermit. TRAINED Religion, Survival. Ability: Discovery. Gear: scroll case, winter blanket, herbalism kit, common clothes, 5 gp.
Career — Healer packet. TRAINED Medicine; Religion is already TRAINED so it becomes EXPERT. Healer's kit (10) and a clergy contact. Age: Steinfolk base 25 + 4 = 29.
Class — Priest. HP 10 + 8 + 3 = 21. Recovery d8. Fortitude / Reflex / Acuity TRAINED (+2), Resolve EXPERT (+4). TRAINED Religion already EXPERT, so she picks Medicine (already TRAINED → EXPERT), plus Diplomacy and Nature. Class gold 12 gp. Doctrine: Core Rulebook, Priest. Powers: 3 Techniques, 2 Exploits, 1 Gambit from the Priest lists.
Sheet math (unarmoured, no shield). AC 10 + max(0, 2)+2 = 14 if she is TRAINED in unarmoured defence (Priest is). Fortitude 10+max(1, 3)+2 = 15. Reflex 10+max(0, 0)+2 = 12. Acuity 10+max(1, −1)+2 = 13. Resolve 10 + max(3, 2) + 4 = 17.
Gold. 5+12 = 17 gp after background and class, plus the kit from the packet. She buys padded armour (2 sp) or saves for later. Explorer's Pack is 10 gp if the RM wants her travelling-ready.
Rift Mark. "I am the only person I know who heard the Singing Rift and walked away still herself." Alignment: Neutral Good.

The Core Rulebook's longer walkthrough (Yrsa as a two-term Rift Surveyor) is the same person on the full life-path. Use that version when you want career events and mishaps.

Appendix A

Where to Look Next

You have a filled 1st-level sheet. Open the Core Rulebook for everything this booklet left as a name.

You need	Open this
Attribute questions, proficiency, HP, Wounded / Desperate	Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics
Alignment, Rift Mark, Rift Surges	Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics
Full life-path careers, mishaps, ranks	Core Rulebook, Character Creation
Ancestry features, feats, templates	Core Rulebook, Ancestries
Class features and power lists	Core Rulebook, Classes
Skill actions and feats	Core Rulebook, Skills & Feats
Weapons, armour, kits, magic items	Core Rulebook, Equipment
Spells, psionics, Spell Reserve, Effort	Core Rulebook, Magic & Psionics
Three-action combat, conditions	Core Rulebook, Combat
Travel, weather, downtime	Core Rulebook, Exploration
Conditions list, tables, glossary	Core Rulebook, Appendices
Creatures for the RM	*Bestiary* (separate book)
Running the table	*Rift Master's Guide*

A.0.1 Play Loop

On your turn you have **three actions**. Stride, Strike, Raise a shield, cast a Technique, Command a companion – each costs the number of actions printed on the power. You have one reaction (often Attack of Opportunity, Shield Block, or a class feature) and occasional free actions.

- **Techniques** – at-will. Use them every round.
- **Exploits** – once per encounter. They also refresh when you hit Wounded (50% HP) and again at Desperate (10% HP).
- **Gambits** – once per day. Refresh on a long rest.

Casters also have Spell Reserve; the Psionicist has Effort. Both are in the class entry. Desperate abilities trigger at 10% HP. Full action economy and the Wounded cascade: Core Rulebook, Core Mechanics and Combat.

A.0.2 Honest Limit

This booklet will not teach you to run a fight, a rift, or a social scene by itself. It will get every box on the sheet filled so the table can open the manual at the right chapter instead of at page one.

Appendix B

Character Sheet

This is the same two-page sheet as Core Rulebook Appendix D. Photocopy or print one per player. Chapter 4 says which box each step fills.

TERMINUS RIFT — Character Sheet

CHARACTER NAME _____ PLAYER NAME _____

LEVEL _____ ANCESTRY _____ CLASS _____ OATH / DOCTRINE / TOTEM _____

ATTRIBUTES

Facets of Form

STR	AGI	FIN	STA
Strength	Agility	Finesse	Stamina
SCORE	SCORE	SCORE	SCORE
MOD	MOD	MOD	MOD

Facets of Mind

INT	CUN	INS	WIL
Intellect	Cunning	Insight	Willpower
SCORE	SCORE	SCORE	SCORE
MOD	MOD	MOD	MOD

COMBAT STATS

HIT POINTS
CURRENT _____ / MAX _____
TEMP HP _____

ARMOUR CLASS
TOTAL
= 10 + max(AGI,INS) + Prof + Armour + Shield
BREAKDOWN: _____

SPEED _____ ft.

PERCEPTION MOD _____ RANK _____

RECOVERY DIE DIE _____ + STA _____

RIFT SURGES (1) (2) (3)

EXPOSURE -1 -2 -3 -4 -5

EFFORT CUR _____ MAX _____

DEFENCES

			U	T	E	M	G
FORTITUDE	(STR | STA)	TOTAL _____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
REFLEX	(AGI | FIN)	TOTAL _____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ACUITY	(INT | CUN)	TOTAL _____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
[illegible]		TOTAL	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

SKILLS

			U	T	E	M	G
Acrobatics	AGI	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Arcana	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Astronomy	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Athletics	STR	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Crafting	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Deception	CUN	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Diplomacy	CUN	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Dungeoneering	INT|INS	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Engineering	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Intimidation	STR|CUN	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Lore:	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Medicine	INS	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Navigation	INS	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Nature	INS	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Occultism	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Perception	INS	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Performance	CUN	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Piloting	AGI	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Religion	WIL	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Society	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Stealth	FIN	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Survival	INS	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Technology	INT	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Thievery	FIN	_____	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

WEAPON ATTACKS

WEAPON	ATK	DMG	TRAITS
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
[illegible]			

LANGUAGES

POWERS

TECHNIQUES (AT-WILL)

NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

EXPLOITS (ENCOUNTER)

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

GAMBITS (DAILY)

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

☐ NAME ____ ACT ____ EFFECT ____

SPELL RESERVE POOL TOTAL ____ CURRENT ____

CLASS FEATURES

ANCESTRY FEATURES

EQUIPMENT & INVENTORY

WORN ITEMS (INVESTED)

☐ ____

☐ ____

☐ ____

☐ ____

☐ ____

☐ ____

☐ ____

☐ ____

CARRIED ITEMS

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

____ WT ____

CURRENCY

CP ____ SP ____ GP ____

CAREER TERM SUMMARY

TERM 1 CAREER ____
SKILLS ____ EVENT ____
BENEFIT / MISHAP ____

TERM 2 CAREER ____
SKILLS ____ EVENT ____
BENEFIT / MISHAP ____

TERM 3 CAREER ____
SKILLS ____ EVENT ____
BENEFIT / MISHAP ____

MUSTERING OUT BENEFITS

STORY ELEMENTS

ALIGNMENT — APPARENT ____ KNOWN ____

COSMIC BONDS

RIFT MARK

PERSONALITY / APPEARANCE

ALLIES & CONTACTS

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